Frank Weikai Li (Ph.D., CFA)

Department of Economics and Finance, City University of Hong Kong
LAU 9-239, 83 Tat Chee Avenue, Kowloon Tong, Hong Kong SAR
Email: weikaili@cityu.edu.hk Tel: +852 3442 6764 Homepage:
https://sites.google.com/view/frankweikaili/home

Academic Positions

City University of Hong Kong, College of Business
Associate Professor of Finance, July 2025 – Present

Singapore Management University, Lee Kong Chian School of Business
Assistant Professor of Finance, July 2017 – June 2025

Education

- 2012–2017 **Hong Kong University of Science and Technology**, Hong Kong, China Ph.D. in Finance
- 2015.08–2016.01 **Princeton University**, Bendheim Center for Finance, Princeton, NJ Visiting Researcher
- 2011–2012 **Tulane University**, A.B. Freeman School of Business, New Orleans, LA MSc in Finance
- 2007–2011 **Zhejiang University**, College of Economics, Hangzhou, China B.A. in Economics

Research Interests

Behavioral Finance; Sustainable Finance; Empirical Asset Pricing; International Financial Markets

Selected Publications

1. **Consumers' Reaction to Corporate ESG Performance: Evidence from Store Visits,** with Tinghua Duan and Roni Michaely
   2023 FMA European Best Paper Award in Corporate Finance & Financial Institutions
   Accepted at Management Science

2. **How Firms Adapt to Rising Temperatures: Evidence from U.S. Establishments,** with Zuben Jin, Yupeng Lin, and Zilong Zhang
   Journal of Business Ethics, 2025, 1–29.

3. **Something in the Air: Does Air Pollution Affect Fund Managers' Carbon Divestment?** with Thanh D. Huynh and Ying Xia
   FIRN Annual Conference Best Paper Prize
   Review of Accounting Studies, 2025, Vol. 30, 2607–2634.

4. **The Gender Effects of COVID: Evidence from Equity Analysts,** with Baolian Wang
   Review of Accounting Studies, 2025, Vol. 30, 1683–1715.

5. **Is Carbon Risk Priced in the Cross-Section of Corporate Bond Returns?** with Tinghua Duan and Quan Wen
   Media Coverage: Advisor Perspectives; THE SRI CHRONICLES; ESSEC-Amundi Chair Research Letters
   GRASFI 2021 Best Asset Pricing Paper Prize
   Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis, 2025, Vol. 60(1), 1–35.

6. **Exchange-Traded Funds and Real Investment,** with Constantinos Antoniou, Xuewen Liu, Avanidhar Subrahmanyam, and Chengzhu Sun
   Media Coverage: UCLA Anderson Review
   Review of Financial Studies, 2023, Vol. 36(3), 1043–1093.

7. **Short Selling ETFs,** with Qifei Zhu
   Media Coverage: Citywire; Financial Times
   2016 AFBC PhD Forum Best Paper Award (first prize)
   Review of Asset Pricing Studies, 2022, Vol. 12(4), 960–998.

8. **Inside Brokers,** with Abhiroop Mukherjee and Rik Sen
   Journal of Financial Economics, 2021, Vol. 141, 1096–1118.

9. **Security Analysts and Capital Market Anomalies,** with Li Guo and K.C. John Wei
   Research Paper Award for 26th Theories and Practices of Securities and Financial Markets
   2019 Hillcrest Behavioral Finance Award (Honorable Mention)
   Journal of Financial Economics, 2020, Vol. 137, 204–230.
   《清华金融评论》分析师将价格推向何方?
   Media Coverage: Academic Insights on Investing; Alpha Architect

10. **The Information Content of Sudden Insider Silence,** with Claire Yurong Hong
    2016 FMA Asia Best Paper Award in Asset Pricing/Investments
    2017 Asian Finance Association Best Paper Award
    Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis, 2019, Vol. 54(4), 1499–1538.

11. **Climate Risks and Market Efficiency,** with Harrison Hong and Jiangmin Xu
    The most cited articles from *Journal of Econometrics* published since 2018.
    Journal of Econometrics, 2019, 208(1), 265–281.

12. **Macro Disagreement and the Cross-Section of Stock Returns**
    2015 Chicago Quantitative Alliance (Asia) Academic Competition (Second Prize)
    (Lead Article)
    Review of Asset Pricing Studies, 2016, Vol. 6(1), 1–45.
    Podcast in Chinese: 如何用宏观经济指标预测股价变动?

Other Publications

1. **Global Infrastructure PE Fund Performance: Does ESG Matter?** with Victor Ong and Jianing Wei
   The Journal of ESG and Impact Investing, 2026, Vol. 6(3), 110–128.

2. **A Behavioral Signaling Explanation for Stock Splits,** with Chenyu Cui, Jiaren Pang, and Deren Xie
   Financial Management, forthcoming.

3. **Do Factor Models Capture both Sentiment and Limited Attention?** with Xinrui Duan, Li Guo, and Jun Tu
Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control, 2025, Vol. 181, 105203.

4. **Major Customers and Carbon Footprints along the Supply Chain,** with Saiying Deng, Tinghua Duan, and Xiaoling Pu
Journal of Corporate Finance, 2025, Vol. 92, 102752.

5. **Geographic Links and Predictable Returns,** with Zuben Jin
2020 Crowell Memorial Award for Best Paper in Quantitative Investments (Second Prize)
Journal of Business Finance and Accounting, 2024, Vol. 51, 2239–2274.

6. **Climate Change Concerns and Mortgage Lending,** with Tinghua Duan
Journal of Empirical Finance, 2024, Vol. 75, 101445.

7. **Information Acquisition and Expected Returns: Evidence from EDGAR Search Traffic,** with Chengzhu Sun
Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control, 2022, Vol. 141, 104384.

8. **Acquiring Organizational Capital,** with Peixin Li, Baolian Wang and Zilong Zhang
Finance Research Letters, 2018, Vol. 25, 30–35.

Active Working Papers

1. **Financial Intermediaries and Comovement in Market Efficiency: The Case of ETFs,** with Claire Yurong Hong, Jiang Luo, and Avanidhar Subrahmanyam
Presented at: HKIMR; ABFER 2022; IÉSEG School of Management; Stockholm University; NUS; CIRF 2022; SFS Cavalcade Asia-Pacific 2022; 2023 SMU Summer Camp; NFA 2023; Monash University; Australian National University.
Media Coverage: Alpha Architect
R&R at Review of Financial Studies

2. **The Local Downside Risk Premium,** with Zilong Niu
Presented at: AsianFA 2024; SUFE; 2024 European Winter Meeting; 1st Asian Quantitative and Macro Investment Conference; AFBC 2025.
R&R at Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis

3. **Naïve Earnings Growth Extrapolation,** with Chenyu Cui and Xinyi Zhang
Presented at: CICF 2021; China Investment Corporation; ABRI Seminar; NTU; Heritage Capital Management; SMU; Bank of America; 2022 Research in Behavioral Finance Conference.
R&R at Review of Accounting Studies

4. **Does Abstract Thinking Facilitate Information Processing? Evidence from Financial Analysts,** with Zuben Jin, Rong Wang, and Gloria Yu
Presented at: FMA Asia-Pacific 2022; SMU Summer Camp.

5. **Do Carbon Pricing Policies Harm Firm Performance? Worldwide Evidence,** with Tinghua Duan and Hong Zhang
Presented at: HKIMR; University of Manchester; Lancaster University; SAIF; SMU; ABFER 2024; Zhejiang University; CICF 2024; 2024 IFMA; SUFE; Paris December Finance Meeting 2024; ABRI-CKGSB Seminar; CityU of HK; MFA 2025; GRASFI 2025; FMA Asia 2025; Inaugural GRASFI Asia Conference.

6. **Scope Similarity and Cross-Firm Return Predictability,** with Zuben Jin and Wenquan Li
   Presented at: MRS 2026
   R&R at Journal of Banking and Finance

7. **Predicting the Unpredictable: Representative Bias and Speculative Trading in Stock Market,** with Chenyu Cui and Xinyi Zhang
   Presented at: China Financial Research Conference; AFR International Conference of Economics and Finance; CUHK-Shenzhen Forum of Asian Accounting Scholars; Nanjing University of Science and Technology; Qube Research & Technologies.

8. **Shifting the Spotlight: Do Firms Change Their Advertising Strategies after ESG Reputational-Damaging Events,** with Tinghua Duan, Rencheng Wang, and Yin Wang
   Presented at: Shanghai Jiaotong University; SMU Accounting Research Summer Camp; Dishui Lake International Conference in Finance; Zhejiang University; Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University; Tongji University; ARCS conference.

9. **Active Firms in Passive Markets? ETF Ownership, Information Production, and Voluntary Disclosure,** with Jiayu Dai, Kevin Tseng and Bochen Wu
   Presented at: FIRN Asset Management Meeting; ABR–Fudan Joint Conference; Southwestern University of Finance and Economics.

10. **Salient Cues of Economic Transitions in Analyst Forecasting: Evidence from the Electric Vehicle Era,** with Xueqing Geng, Jarrad Harford, and Yonghao Zhai
    Presented at: SMU Summer Camp 2025; FMA 2025; ABR-Fudan Joint Conference; Fudan University; Nankai University; Renmin University of China; Singapore Scholars Symposium 2025; MFA 2026; HEC-HKUST-NUS Sustainable Finance Webinar.
    AFBC 2025 CFA Institute's Best Paper on Sustainable Investment

11. **The Gender Effects of Paid Sick Leave Mandates on Labor Performance: Evidence from Equity Analysts,** with Shunlan Fang and Xiaoling Pu
    Presented at: HKU Governance & Sustainability Conference; FMA Asia 2025; Accounting Alumni Conference of Temple University; CICF 2026; ARCS conference.

12. **Deepseeking Investment Value through Analyst Reports,** with Guiyun Li and Zilong Niu
    Presented at: Shanghai Jiaotong University; City University of Macau; 2026 Asian FA; 2026 ABFER-JFDS Conference on AI for Finance

13. **When Money Tightens: Monetary Policy and Payment Delays,** with Yanduo Chen and Jing Wu

14. **Tracking High-Frequency Trading Activity in China and Its Effect on Market Quality,** with Li Guo, Ding Qi, and Lijian Sun
    Presented at: HKUST(Guangzhou); 2026 MRS International Risk Conference

15. **Do Carbon Border Taxes Induce Reshoring? Early Evidence from the EU CBAM,** with Chengzhu Sun and Anthony Xu
    Presented at: CUHK(Shenzhen); SKK Graduate School of Business; KAIST;

Resting Working Papers

1. **ETF Momentum,** with Melvyn Teo and Chloe (Chunliu) Yang

2. **Do Foreign Institutional Investors Deter Opportunistic Insider Trading?** with Claire Yurong Hong and Qifei Zhu
   Presented at: Singapore Scholars Symposium 2018; Volatility Institute Conference at NYU Shanghai; Lixin Law and Finance Workshop; Five Star Forum in Finance; SFS Cavalcade Asia-Pacific 2018; Journal of Law, Finance, and Accounting Conference; 2019 SMU Summer Camp; CICF 2019; NFA 2019.

3. **Days to Cover and Stock Returns,** with Harrison Hong, Sophie X. Ni, Jose A. Scheinkman and Philip Yan
   Presented at: 2016 AFBC PhD Forum; EFA 2015; CICF 2016; AFA 2016.
   Media Coverage: Wall Street Journal; Alpha Architect; AllAboutAlpha
   2016 CICF Best Paper Award

Academic Citation/Impact

- **Google Scholar Citation**: >2,600
- **Web of Science**: >900
- **Scopus Citation**: >900
- **SSRN Downloads**: >32,000

Conference Discussions

- 2026: CICF; CityU International Finance Conference; UBS Quant Investment Forum: AI and Finance; Workshop on AI, Big Data, and SciTech Finance
- 2025: CICF; Hong Kong-Shenzhen Joint Finance Research Workshop; Asian Corporate Finance Online Workshop; China International Forum on Finance and Policy
- 2024: CICF; PHBS Finance Symposium; CFRC; SOAR Accounting Symposium 2024; SFS Cavalcade Asia-Pacific
- 2023: ABFER; CICF; Conference on Asia-Pacific Financial Markets
- 2022: China Financial Research Conference; AsianFA; China International Risk Forum; RUC-VUW Joint Virtual Research Workshop; FMA Asia-Pacific
- 2021: Midwest Finance Association Annual Conference; ABFER; CICF; China International Risk Forum
- 2020: ZJU Finance Alumni Mini Conference
- 2019: CICF; Journal of Law, Finance, and Accounting Conference; TBLI-SKBI Sustainable Finance 2019 Asia Conference; SFS Cavalcade Asia-Pacific
- 2018: AsianFA; SFS Cavalcade Asia-Pacific
- 2017: CICF; FIRS; SFS Cavalcade Asia-Pacific
- 2016: CICF; FMA Asia; AFBC
- 2015: Asian FA

Ph.D. and DBA Dissertation Committee

- **JIN Zuben** (chair): Assistant Professor at Institute of Financial Studies (IFS) of Southwestern University of Finance and Economics
- **LI Haoyuan**: Assistant Professor at University of International Business and Economics
- **LI Jiangyuan**: Assistant Professor at Shanghai University of Finance and Economics
- **CHEN Zilin**: Assistant Professor at Southwestern University of Finance and Economics
- **FAN Qi**: Postdoctoral Research Fellow at HKUST
- **GUAN Jianlin**: ZJU-SMU DBA, 2023
- **ZHANG Chengshuang Kathy**: SMU DBA, 2023
- **XU Mei**: ZJU-SMU DBA, 2023
- **WANG Dandan**: ZJU-SMU DBA, 2024
- **ZHOU Jian**: ZJU-SMU DBA, 2024
- **HAN Zhiyong**: ZJU-SMU DBA, 2024
- **JIANG Yifan**: ZJU-SMU DBA, 2025
- **LUO Jiehui**: ZJU-SMU DBA, 2026

Honors and Awards

- 2025 AFBC CFA Institute's Best Paper on Sustainable Investment
- 2023 PwC 3535 Finance Forum Best Paper Award (2 papers)
- 2023 FMA European Best Paper Award in Corporate Finance & Financial Institutions
- Lee Kong Chian Fellow, 2022–2023
- 2022 FIRN Annual Conference Best Paper Prize
- 2021 GRASFI Best Asset Pricing Paper Prize
- 2020 Crowell Memorial Prize (2nd prize), PanAgora Asset Management Academic Competition
- 2019 Hillcrest Behavioural Finance Award (Honorable Mention)
- 2019 WRDS Advanced Research Scholar Program Best Paper Award
- Research Paper Award for 26th Theories and Practices of Securities and Financial Markets
- 2017 Asian Finance Association Best Paper Award
- 2016 AFBC PhD Forum Best Paper Award (first prize)
- 2016 FMA Asia Best Paper Award in Asset Pricing/Investments
- 2016 CICF Best Paper Award
- Second Prize, Chicago Quantitative Alliance (Asia) Academic Competition, 2015
- Overseas Research Awards for PhD students, HKUST, 2015–2016
- 2× Dean's Scholarship for Research Excellence, HKUST, 2014–2015, 2016–2017
- Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corporation Scholarship, 2010
- National Scholarship, Ministry of Education of the People's Republic of China, 2009

Research Grants

- Principal Investigator, Open-bid Applied Research Programme of Hong Kong Institute for Monetary and Financial Research, "Deepseeking Investment Value through Analyst Reports," USD 15,000. 2026.10 – 2027.3.
- CityU Start-up Grant for New Faculty, "The Gender Effects of Paid Sick Leave Mandates on Labor Performance: Evidence from Equity Analysts,", HKD 300,000, 2025.9 – 2027.8.
- Co-PI, MOE AcRF Tier 3 Grant Type C, "Climate Transformation Programme" (MOET32022-0006), SGD 45,900,000, 2023.12 – 2030.11.
- Collaborator, "Research on insurance asset allocation considering green development", The National Natural Science Foundation of China (No. 72371256), CNY 390,000, 2024.1–2027.12.
- Principal Investigator, Regular Research Programme of Hong Kong Institute for Monetary and Financial Research, "The Effect of Carbon Pricing on Firm Performance: Worldwide Evidence", USD 4,000. 2023.5 – 2023.10.
- Principal Investigator, ASEAN Business Research Initiative (LKCSB-CKGSB) Research Grant (2023–2024), "Carbon Pricing and Firm Performance: Global Evidence," SGD 7,900.
- Institute for Quantitative Investment (INQUIRE Europe) Research Grant, "The Effect of Carbon Pricing on Firm Performance: Worldwide Evidence," Euro 10,000. 2023.4 – 2024.3.
- Principal Investigator, Open-bid Applied Research Programme of Hong Kong Institute for Monetary and Financial Research, "Lead Market Maker-Level Comovement in ETF Premium," USD 7,000. 2021.6 – 2021.11.
- Collaborator, Theme-based Research Scheme (Project no. T31-603/21-N), "Developing Hong Kong as a Global Green Finance Centre," HKD 36,464,000.
- Principal Investigator, ASEAN Business Research Initiative (LKCSB-CKGSB) Research Grant (2021–2022), "Do Investors Extrapolate Earnings Growth? Evidence from China," SGD 9,000.
- Principal Investigator, Ministry of Education (MOE) Tier 1 Academic Research Fund 2020–2021, "Geographic Links and Predictable Returns," SGD 30,217.
- Principal Investigator, ASEAN Business Research Initiative (LKCSB-CKGSB) Research Grant (2020–2021), "The Chinese Stock Splits Puzzle: A Behavioral Signaling Explanation," SGD 11,100.
- Principal Investigator, Ministry of Education (MOE) Tier 1 Academic Research Fund 2019–2020, "Climate Risk and Mortgage Origination," SGD 30,000.

Professional Service

Editorial Roles

- **Associate Editor,** Pacific-Basin Finance Journal (2025.3 – Present)
- **Associate Editor,** Asia-Pacific Journal of Financial Studies (2026.3 – Present)
- **Associate Editor,** Asia Pacific Journal of Accounting & Economics (2026.7 – Present)

Referee for Journals

- Journal of Finance (×2); Review of Financial Studies (×12); Journal of Financial Economics; Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences; American Economic Review: Insights; Review of Economics and Statistics; Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis (×9); Management Science (×16); Review of Finance (×5); Review of Asset Pricing Studies (×3); Journal of Empirical Finance (×8); Journal of Banking and Finance (×14); Journal of Corporate Finance (×4); Financial Management (×8); Research Policy; Journal of Environmental Economics and Management (×3); Journal of Financial Markets; Journal of Money, Credit and Banking; Journal of Business, Finance & Accounting; Pacific-Basin Finance Journal (×12); Real Estate Economics (×2); Asia-Pacific Journal of Financial Studies; Financial Analysts Journal (×3); Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control (×2); British Accounting Review; China Accounting and Finance Review; Journal of Business Ethics; International Review of Finance; Financial Review; European Journal of Finance; Hong Kong Institute for Monetary and Financial Research (×2)

Reviewer for Grants

- Research Grants Council of Hong Kong SAR, China (RGC) (2018 to 2025)
- INTER Mobility of the Luxembourg National Research Fund (2021)

Conference Program/Review Committee

- 2026 FMA Annual Meeting Program Committee
- Program Committee for 2026 MRS International Risk Conference
- Program Committee for the 2026 Baruch/JFQA Climate Finance and Sustainability Conference
- Reviewer for 2024 and 2025 GRASFI Conference
- Associate Program Chair for the 2023 and 2024 Northern Finance Association Meeting
- Reviewer for 2021, 2024, and 2025 Midwest Finance Association Annual Conference
- Reviewer for 2020 China Finance Scholar Forum

Teaching Experience

- 2026 – present: Financial Systems, Markets and Instruments
- 2025 – present: Empirical Asset Pricing
- 2024 Fall & 2025 Spring: Sustainable Finance
- 2020 & 2022 Spring: Research Topics in Finance (co-instructor for PhD in Business (Finance) course)
- 2020–2024 Spring: Financial Markets and Investments
- 2018 & 2019 Spring: Financial Instruments, Institutions and Markets

School Service

- Faculty Sponsors of SFS Cavalcade Asia-Pacific 2026
- PhD Coordinator, City University of Hong Kong (2025 – 2026)
- Recruiting Committee, City University of Hong Kong (2025 – present)

- Organizer, 2025 SMU Summer Camp
- Finance area seminar coordinator (2018–2020), Singapore Management University
- Local organizer, Singapore Scholars Symposium (2018, 2019)
- Ph.D. in Business (Finance) Admission Committee (2017, 2018), Singapore Management University

Professional Affiliations

- Member, American Finance Association, 2016–Present
- Member, European Finance Association, 2017–Present
- Member, Financial Management Association, 2016–Present
- Member, Beta Gamma Sigma HKUST Chapter, 2018–Present
- Representative Member, European Corporate Governance Institute, 2024–Present
- Affiliated Researcher at the HKU's Research Institute on Governance, Environment and Social, 2025–Present